Sam H

Joanne Tully

From: Garnier, Chrystèle <Chrystele.Garnier@highwaysengland.co.uk>
Sent: Thursday, June 04, 2015 3:21 PM
To: SBC Development Control
Cc: 'Chris.Sibthorpe@jmp.co.uk'; Sandy, Rachel; Claire Cornelius; Sam Howell
Subject: S/OUT/13/1555 Eastern Villages - Highways England's Comments
Attachments: Eastern Villages_20150604_Signed Highways England 6-month Direction of Non-approval Renewal.pdf

BAJ

Importance: High

Swindon Borough Council
Planning Department
5 JUN 2015

Hi

Please see attached for your consideration.

Regards,

Chrystèle Garnier, Business Support
Highways England | Temple Quay House | 2 The Square, Temple Quay | Bristol | BS1 6HA
Tel: +44 (0) 117 3728197
Web: http://www.highways.gov.uk
GTN: 1371 8197

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Our ref: A419
Your ref: S/OUT/13/1555

Ms Rachel Sandy
Asset Manager
2/07K
Temple Quay House
2 The Square, Temple Quay
Bristol
BS1 6HA

Direct Line: 0117 372 8843
Fax: 0117 372 8100

03 June 2015

Sam Howell
Swindon Borough Council
Wat Tyler House
Beckhampton Street
Swindon
SN1 2JH

For the attention of Miss Sam Howell

Dear Sam,

S/OUT/13/1555 – EASTERN VILLAGES SOUTH MARSTON AND ROWBOROUGH

Thank you for consulting Highways England on the latest transport assessment relating to the above development. Our response is attached.

Please note that we are recommending that the application not be determined for a further 6 months from the expiry of the current direction on 4 June 2015.

Please contact me if you wish to discuss this further

Yours sincerely,

Rachel Sandy
Asset Manager
NDD South West – Growth and Improvement Team
Email:rachel.sandy@highwaysengland.co.uk

highways
england

Developments Affecting Trunk Roads and Special Roads

Highways England Response & Formal Recommendation to an Application for Planning Permission

From: Divisional Director, Network Delivery and Development, South West Region, Highways England.

To: Swindon Borough Council

CC: DfT c/o Highways England Growth and Economic Development Team

Council's Reference: S/OUT/13/1555

Referring to the notification of a planning application(s) registered 18 October 2013 referenced above, in connection with the A419 urban extension for up to 2,380 dwellings, a mixed use local centre and mixed use areas, community uses, sheltered accommodation, a primary school, green infrastructure including formal and informal open space, sports facilities, sustainable drainage, engineering works including ground re-modelling, other infrastructure, demolition and the formation of new accesses from the A420, Old Vicarage Lane, Thornhill Road at New Eastern Villages Land North of the A420 South Marston and Rowborough, Swindon, notice is hereby given that Highways England's formal recommendation is that we:

~~a) offer no objection;~~

~~b) recommend that conditions should be attached to any planning permission that may be granted (see Annex A – Highways England recommended Planning Conditions);~~

c) recommend that planning permission not be granted for a specified period (see Annex A – non determination);

~~d) recommend that the application be refused (see Annex A – Reasons for recommending Refusal).~~

Should you decide to not accept this Recommendation you have 21 days to make a challenge, through referral to the Secretary of State for Transport (SoSfT).

Signed by

Date: 04/06/15	**Signature:**
Name: Rachel Sandy	**Position:** Asset Manager
Highways England: Temple Quay House, 2 The Square, Temple Quay, Bristol,	

BS1 6HA

Annex A **Highways England recommended Planning Conditions / Highways England recommended non-determination / Highways England recommended Refusal.**

HIGHWAYS ENGLAND ("we") has been appointed by the Secretary of State for Transport as strategic highway company under the provisions of the Infrastructure Act 2015 and is the highway authority, traffic authority and street authority for the Strategic Road Network (SRN). The SRN is a critical national asset and as such works to ensure that it operates and is managed in the public interest, both in respect of current activities and needs as well as in providing effective stewardship of its long-term operation and integrity.

This response represents our formal recommendations with regard to planning application reference S/OUT/13/1555 and has been prepared by Rachel Sandy of the Network Delivery and Development Growth and Improvement Team and Asset Manager for the SRN in Wiltshire.

We have undertaken a review of the relevant documents supporting the planning application to ensure compliance with the current requirements as detailed in DfT Circular 02/2013 "The Strategic Road Network and the Delivery of Sustainable Development " and the DCLG National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF), being advised on this matter by our consultants, CH2M.

Statement of Reasons

Further to our March 2015 letter setting out concerns regarding revision 3 of the transport assessment, Highways England is grateful for the additional information provided (transport assessment revision 4) which has addressed a number of issues raised previously. However we are disappointed to note that there are still a number of outstanding issues from our original review which have not yet been fully addressed. For completeness we have highlighted these under the following chapter headings:

General Transport Assessment Comments

The comparative masterplan with a list of development proposals between that tested by CH2M and JMP on behalf of the developer and that shown in the TA has still not been provided. This is required in order that the link between the modelling undertaken and the development proposals can be firmly established.

In the event that further iterations of the masterplan are undertaken this piece of evidence will also permit Highways England to easily understand where changes have been made to the application.

Chapter 4 – Existing Transport Conditions

Some additional discussions have been added in the revised TA with regards to the safety concerns at the White Hart roundabout. We consider the White Hart improvements need to be investigated in more detail in terms of the accident records and the improvements the proposed signal junction design will bring. The junction improvement should be presented in the TA and shown to comply with DMRB guidance. This includes an assessment of whether the scheme will require departures from standard. Once confirmed the design would need to be accompanied with a road safety

audit. Further information to analyse the collision patterns to the south of the Hyde Road and either side of the Blunsden junction have not been provided, as previously requested. The detailed reports for the 5 year PIA records should be included in the TA as Appendix, as this would be helpful for the TA review.

Chapter 5 – Development Proposals
The discussion of development phases remains unchanged in the TA (Section 5.5 to 5.15) which describes the phasing of the development in generic terms. A more detailed phasing plan with quantum of development and access points at each phase should be provided, as previously requested. This would help determine appropriate triggers for the delivery / implementation of the mitigation measures.

It is acknowledged that a more detailed public transport analysis will be carried out for the bus patronage when the proposed development in place. However, the analysis does not show how it relates to the development phasing as expected, nor does it explain how or if the bus service or other travel plan measures will increase bus patronage. The methodology used for the forecast weekly trips using TEMPRO data appears reasonable, but we request the output for this be provided. The calculations in the tables do not seem correct and also, there is discrepancy between the total number of 2940 occupations in the Figure 5e and the dwelling number of 2380 stated in the scheme proposal. We assume that this is because the South Marston element of 560 dwellings has been excluded. However we would be grateful if you could confirm.

Clarification on the derivation of weekly trips together with further justification for the forecast costs and income figures are therefore required to determine how feasible such a contribution would be and how such a service would help minimise trips on the SRN along with the development phasing.

Chapter 6 – Development Impact Appraisal
A detailed phasing plan should be provided, as previously requested. This would help Highways England understand the number of dwellings and associated trips forecast through the build out, which can be used to identify any gaps before proposed mitigation measures are built out.

Chapter 8 – Development Trip Generation
This section provides the development trip generation and distribution which have been agreed with the Highways England and SBC.

The modelling tests have now included a 2016 opening year assessment with the full application proposal and a 2026 forecast year assessment with the proposed application site plus future development at Eastern Villages. Further clarification for each scenario would be beneficial providing the information such as: which base network for each scenario – the existing network or existing with the proposed development link road? When will the highway intervention be introduced to the existing network and which model results relate to the junction improvements? This would help determine traffic changes on the SRN at each phase as well as resultant changes from the proposed infrastructure intervention when the proposed development in place.

Chapter 9 – Local Road Network Review – Journey Times
As previously stated, the junction and the network performance which were based on the GEH statistics in the TA were not appropriate to assess the impact of the development traffic. The traffic assessment have been modified using the comparisons between scenarios for the journey times, link flows and queue lengths. This is

considered an acceptable approach to assess the traffic impact from the development. It is recommended that TA should be amended with more reference to the new assessments and less reliance on the GEH statistics.

Additional discussions regarding the journey time increase on the Route 3 appear reasonable. However, further analysis for the journey time on the route 7 & Route 8 alongside the queue length analysis is not provided, as previously requested. The evidence of journey time improvement with the introduction of the mitigation strategy, stated in section 9.8 of the TA, needs to be provided.

Chapter 10 – Link Flow Assessment

The link flows can be used to predict the traffic changes arising from the proposed development. The use of the modelling output comparisons between scenarios for link flows is considered acceptable. However this approach does not provide a clear picture of congestion on the SRN. This is discussed in the junction assessment section.

Chapter 11 – Junction Assessment

The junction assessment section remains largely unchanged from the previous TA version which provides some level of analysis / comparisons in queue lengths between scenarios tested. However the context of whether these queues block back to the mainline onto the mainline is not discussed. For example, the results in Figure 11m for the Rat Trap roundabout indicate that the queues on the western approach (i.e. A419 northbound off slip) in 2026 with development is high (i.e. the queue length is 680 metres in 2026, an increase of 54.7% from the 2026 base), but there is no further analysis to explain if the queuing would block back to the A419 mainline and thereby affect the operation of the SRN. It is therefore difficult to draw a conclusion as to whether the increase in queue lengths could be considered to have a material impact.

It is appreciated that a large number of junctions have been assessed. A comparison in queue length between the existing junction and the junction with the proposed highway interventions relating to the development phasing is recommended. At the White Hart Junction and Gablecross Roundabout, the modelling results suggest that there are increases in queuing in both 2016 and 2026 scenarios. Again this needs to be contextualised in terms of whether these queues would adversely impact on the operation of the mainline carriageway in terms of safety and capacity.

Paragraph 11.50 of the TA states that potential signal linkage between the Gablecross roundabout and the White Hart roundabout may minimise the queuing. Further analysis on the outputs from the modelling and the interaction between the two is therefore required to substantiate this comment.

Position and Summary

Since the issue of the previous version of your transport assessment, Highways England has held a number of meetings with Swindon Borough Council (SBC). The discussions have centred around the need to bring forward the timely delivery of Eastern Villages mitigation in a coordinated and managed way which minimises the construction impact to the SRN and also avoids potentially abortive infrastructure provision. With more surety and confidence relating to future funding streams and the timing of the delivery of works identified in the infrastructure delivery plan, Highways England are now of the view that an 'opening year' scheme such as that suggested in the TA for the White Hart Junction is unlikely to be required since the design life of these proposals would be short and would in effect require two sets of construction

works over a very short duration of time. The consequent disruption to the travelling public would therefore be severe.

On this basis, Highways England is supportive of SBC's approach for a funding contribution to be made by the developer towards the full package of measures. This would not only need to extend to the White Hart proposals but also parts of the SRN which are affected by your works. Most notably this includes M4 J15 and the Commonhead Junction where a scheme has been identified which accommodates both Eastern Villages and Commonhead traffic.

The caveat is if the funding identified does not materialise. Under these circumstances we would need to consider your 'opening year' mitigation in more detail. It is therefore considered imperative that there is an alternative means of mitigating your development in the unlikely event that funding is not forthcoming. On this basis we would encourage you to address the issues that we have raised in this letter. These can be summarised as:

- Provision of the comparative masterplan and detailed phasing plan;
- Provision of the accident analysis at either side of the Blunsdon Road and on Hyde Road;
- Further explanation on the public transport forecast with proposed contribution;
- Further explanation on the junction / network performance with the signal linkage between the White Hart roundabout and Gablecross roundabout.
- Further explanatory text on the significance of the queuing

We look forward to continued dialogue and working in partnership to resolve these issues.

Recommendation:
Further to the above, Highways England recommends preventing the granting of planning permission for application reference S/OUT/13/1555 for a period of 6 months from the date of this recommendation to allow the application time to submit the additional information and for ongoing discussions to take place.

I trust the above is clear. Please do not hesitate to contact me should you wish to discuss any further issues.